

Berkay Gülen, PhD

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My **experience** in **user research** across four countries and my methodological expertise in mixed-method **research** through my PhD training equip me to lead projects based on evidence and represent **user** voices effectively. I excel at collaborating with cross-functional and agile teams in B2B and SaaS while applying **design thinking** to web, mobile, and internal platforms.

Professional **Experience**

Senior **User Experience (UX) Researcher**

Alaska Airlines (via Photon), Internal Technology Systems, SeaTac, WA 10/2023 to Present

- **Establishing UXR practices as the inaugural researcher** to ensure that internal tools help employees perform their jobs effectively, while minimizing friction and frustration.
- Addressing **\$20 million in mishandled claims** by driving the development of AI-powered features (e.g., chat and notifications) through **research**-backed insights, leading to a **15% reduction in claims processing time**.
- Advocating for 2,000+ users across 3 countries and achieving a **25% increase in user satisfaction** within one year by delivering actionable insights to diverse stakeholders.
- Spearheading **research planning** across **3 design teams**, defining **research** scopes and leading to enhanced **collaboration** and alignment on **user**-centered **design** objectives.

UX Researcher

Google (via Aquent), Android Auto- Engineering, Kirkland, WA 11/2022 to 09/2023

- Independently led end-to-end **research** projects in an agile environment over the course of one year, directly influencing Android Auto features for over **200 million drivers**, resulting in a **22% increase in user satisfaction** and enhanced driving safety **metrics**.
- Planned, recruited, and executed mixed-method studies, improved feature adoption, and a **15% rise in System Usability Scale scores**, ultimately enhancing the overall **user experience**.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams, including PMs, designers, engineers, and data scientists. Insights from these efforts led to a **25% increase in positive user feedback**.

UX Researcher

Consultant, Seattle, WA 03/2020 to 10/2022

Client: KaiBeauty Aromatherapy

- Identified a new target audience, unlocked additional revenue streams and drove **sales increases of 25% and 38%** for two key products compared to the previous two quarters.
- Recommended website and social media enhancements to align with customer expectations, resulting in a **44% increase in overall website outreach** within one month.

Client: Policy Pathways

- Conducted usability studies to understand the expectations of 3 distinct **user** groups, leading to a **52% increase in program applications** compared to the previous year.
- Defined essential website features based on the **integration** of three new content areas, contributing to a **32% rise in website outreach** within three months.

Qualitative Researcher

University of Washington, Seattle, WA

09/2015 to 10/2022

- Applied qualitative **research** methods, including participant recruitment, **research design**, in-depth interviews (**200 hours of interview data**), content **analysis** to gain a comprehensive understanding of the motivations and **decision-making** processes of foreign policymakers.
- Ran ethnographic fieldwork internationally, in **2 different languages in 3 countries**, and handled logistics with a limited budget.
- Designed and delivered more than **240 hours of presentations**, presented **research** findings at **10 national/international conferences**.

Education

University of Washington (UW) (Seattle, WA)

Doctor of Philosophy in International Studies (PhD)

2023

Graduate Certification in **Research Design** and Methods

2017

School of Oriental and African Studies (SOAS), University of London (London, UK)

Master of **Science** in International Politics (MSc)

2012

Middle East Technical University (Ankara, Turkey)

Master of **Science** in International Relations (MSc)

2011

Skills

UX Tools: Qualtrics, SurveyMonkey, Adobe XD, Suzy, Pulse Labs, UserTesting.com, DScout, Maze; Figma and Miro.

Qualitative Methods: ATLAS.ti, NVivo; field studies, diary studies, contextual interviews, usability **testing**, heuristic reviews, benchmarking.

Quantitative Methods: Stata, R, survey **design**, data visualization, A/B **testing**, tree testing, desirability studies, eye tracking.

Language Abilities

Turkish- Native | **French**- Intermediate | **Hebrew**- Basic

Berkay Gulen

- Seattle, WA, US

Contact Information

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Summary

I am a mixed-method **researcher** who has spent 4 years conducting evidence-based **research**...

Work History

Total Work **Experience**: 9 years

- **Sr UX Researcher** Alaska Airlines
Oct 01, 2023
- **UX Researcher** Google, Android Auto Engineering Team
Nov 01, 2022
- **UX Researcher** Consultant
Mar 01, 2020
- **University Of Washington Qualitative Researcher**
Sep 01, 2015

Education

- **Masters** | SOAS, University of London
- **Doctorate** | University of Washington

Languages

- French,

Skills

- **research** - 12 years
- **leadership** - 7 years
- **ux** - 5 years
- **french** - 10 years
- **policies** - 9 years
- **atlas** - 8 years
- **stata** - 8 years
- **metrics** - 7 years
- **design thinking** - 6 years
- **business-to-business** - 5 years
- **usability testing** - 5 years
- **personas** - 3 years
- **usability** - 3 years
- **user research** - 3 years
- **ab testing** - 1 years
- **research design** - 9 years
- **qualitative research** - 8 years
- **budget** - 7 years
- **contextual inquiry** - 7 years
- **decision-making** - 7 years
- **ethnography** - 7 years
- **logistics** - 7 years
- **motivation** - 7 years
- **outreach** - 7 years
- **presentations** - 7 years
- **publications** - 7 years
- **recruitment** - 7 years
- **reporting** - 7 years
- **stakeholder management** - 7 years
- **target audience** - 5 years
- **integration** - 3 years
- **social media** - 3 years
- **software** - 3 years
- **streaming** - 3 years
- **qualitative analysis** - 1 years
- **quantitative analyst** - 1 years
- **focus groups** - 8 years

Work Preferences

- Desired Work Settings: Remote or On-Site or Hybrid
- Likely to Switch: True
- Willing to Relocate: True
- Travel Preference: 25%
- Work Authorization:
 - US
- Work Documents:
 - Employment Auth. Document
- Security Clearance: False
- Third Party: False
- Employment Type:
 - Full-time
 - Contract - Independent
 - Contract - W2
 - Contract to Hire - Independent
 - Contract to Hire - W2

Profile Sources

- linkedin: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/berkay-gulen>
- blog: https://www.canva.com/design/DAE5AbweyiQ/in26FHJ9n-ETmhlz1tpRug/view?utm_content=DAE5AbweyiQ&utm_campaign=designshare&utm_medium=link&utm_source=publishsharelink
- Dice:
<https://www.dice.com/employer/talent/profile/c8215375b93c8587bb06d7c4d130aab1>